faced criticisms for removal of UN peacekeeping forces from Sinai just before the Six-day War on the request of Nasser of Egypt.[17] Still, under his leadership, the office of the Secretary-General gained prestige and he tried to act sincerely to further the purposes and principles of the United Nations.

Kurt Waldheim (Austria), the fourth Secretary-General, played great diplomatic role in a number of crisis situations. He presided over the talks between the Greek and Turkish communities in Cyprus, toured Middle East extensively to promote chances of settlement, and helped the United Nations to undertake practical activities like disaster relief, protecting the international environment, running a world university and administering the deep seabed.[18]

Javier Pèrez de Cuèllar (Peru), the fifth Secretary-General, understood the nerves of the office well as he had worked as the Under Secretary-General of the UN. He undertook some significant peacekeeping operations in Namibia, El Salvador and Cambodia. The waning of the Cold War too helped him to dispense his duties in a proper way. He introduced the concept of quiet diplomacy among the P-5 members of the Security Council to prepare the Council to take an agreed course of action on outstanding issues. Thus, Pèrez de Cuèllar was able to strike peace agreements between contending parties in Namibia, Angola, Mozambique, Nicaragua, El Salvador and Cambodia, and deploy UN peacekeeping forces to supervise elections, disarm military units, and check human rights violations. But during the Gulf Crisis of 1991, the position of the Secretary-General got undermined as the US-led forces overstepped their mandate and in many cases the United States did not keep him fully informed.

Boutros Boutros-Ghali (Egypt), the sixth Secretary-General played an important role in several crisis situations around the world in Somalia, Bosnia and Hebron, among the few. But the most significant contribution he made, using his intellectual excellence, was the 52-page “Agenda for Peace” proposing several reforms for making the United Nations more active and functioning.

Kofi Annan (Ghana), the seventh Secretary-General, tried to make the United Nations more active in facing the crises in the post-Cold